



TANGO: **T**ranslational **A**ugmentations *Necessary Gain or Overhead?*

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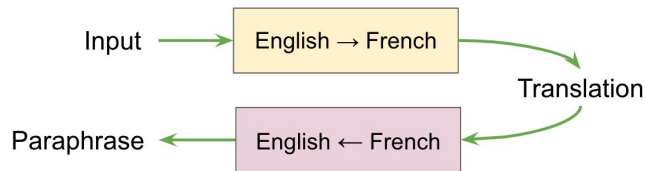
Translational Augmentations: Recap

What is an Augmentation?

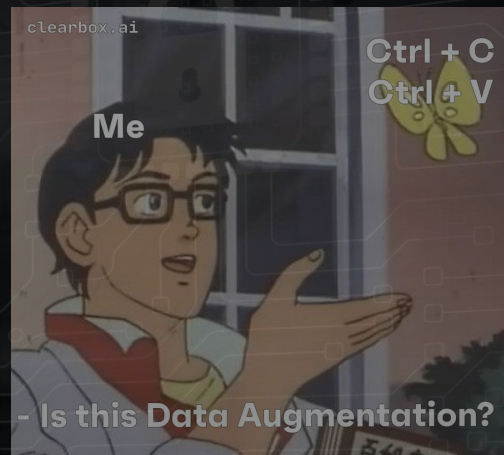
Why do we use it?

Translational Augmentation?

Previously, tea had been used primarily for Buddhist monks to stay awake during meditation.



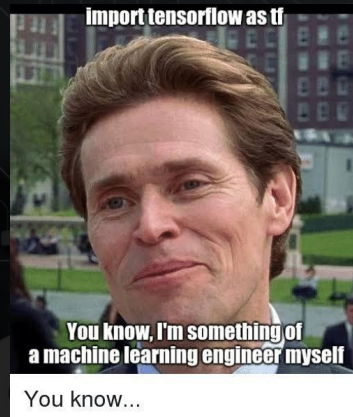
In the past, tea was used mostly for Buddhist monks to stay awake during the meditation.



The Idea

Novelty

- Evaluate translations.
- Benchmark translators.
- Quantify semantics diversity.
- LLM assisted evaluation.



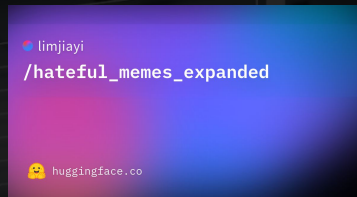
When the teacher asks me to do a self-evaluation:



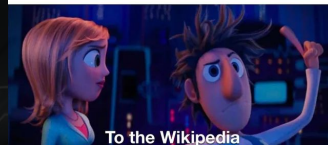
The Idea

Challenges

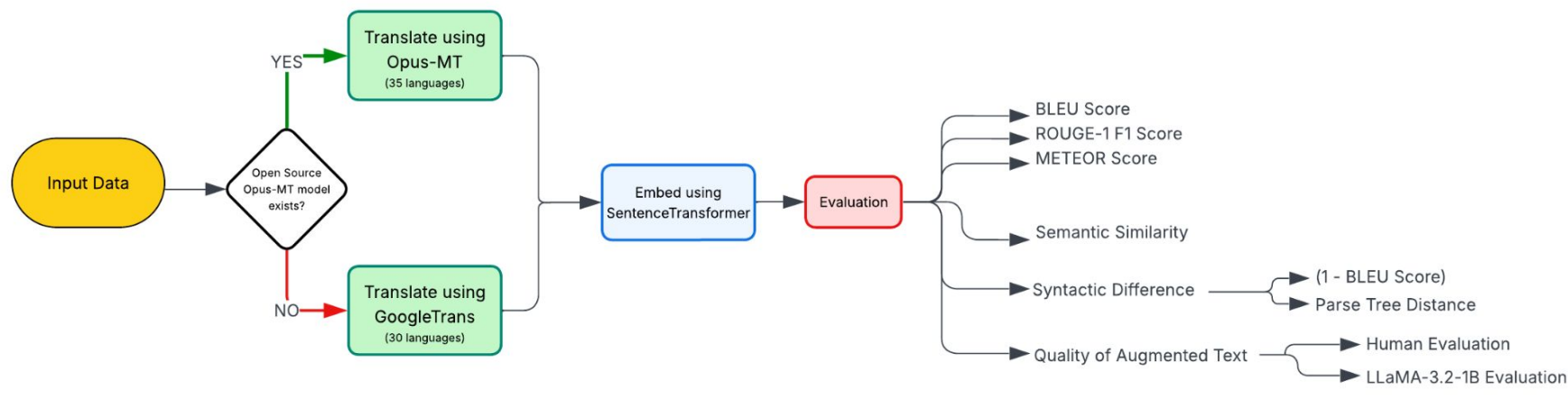
- Dataset
- Can we truly trust statistical evaluations?
- Do our “Self Evaluation” mechanism actually work?
- Looking under the hood: A manual process



When the teacher says you can't use Wikipedia and have to use real sources.
Me:



Our Approach



Evaluation Metrics: How do we quantify and validate the augmentations?

- Statistical Methods:
 - The BLEU (Bilingual Evaluation Understudy)
 - ROUGE-1 F1
 - METEOR
 - Semantic Similarity
 - Syntactic Difference
 - Using (1 - BLEU) Score
 - Parse Tree Distance
- BIG BRAIN (Non traditional) methods:
 - Using a BIOlogical weapon : aka a HOuman
 - LLaMA Eval



Evaluation: Statistical Methods (initial 4)

High-Resource / Languages Similar to English (e.g. *zh, es, fr, de, nl, it, da, sv*) sit at the top of every plot, with medians roughly

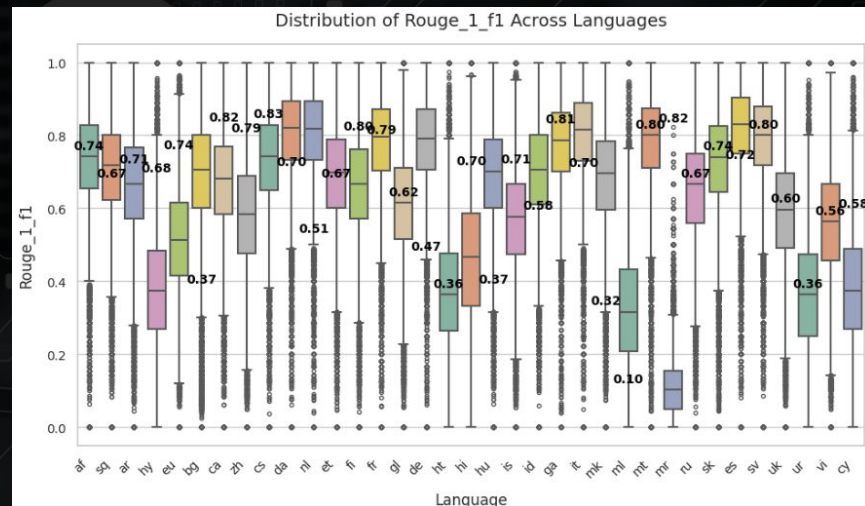
- ROUGE-1 F1 ≥ 0.75
- METEOR ≥ 0.75
- BLEU ≥ 0.50
- SemanticSimilarity ≥ 0.90

Low-Resource / Languages Typologically Distant to English (e.g. *mr, ml, ur, hi, mt, eu*) all drift to the bottom, with medians roughly

- ROUGE-1 F1 ≤ 0.50 (Marathi ~0.10!)
- METEOR ≤ 0.30
- BLEU ≤ 0.10
- Semantic Similarity ≤ 0.50

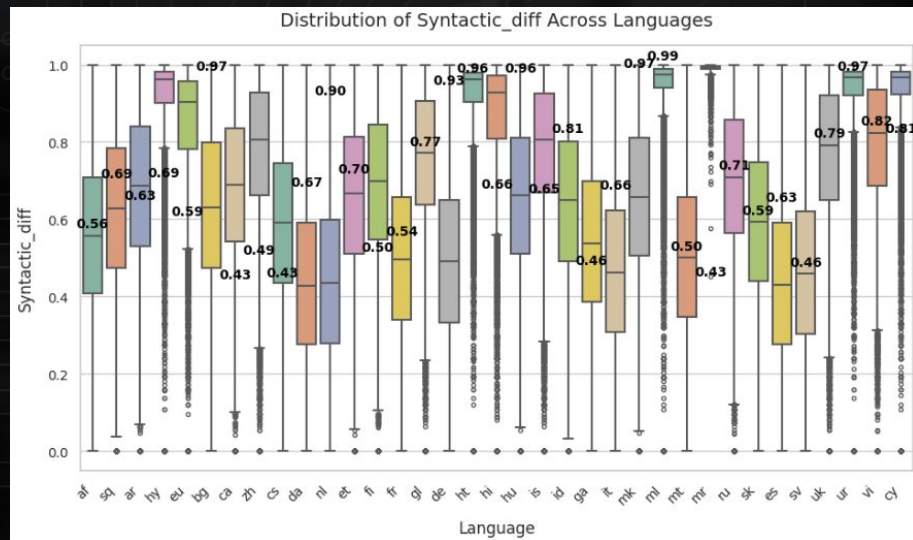
Key Takeaways:

- Back-translations from language close to English are both semantically and lexically close
- Mid-resource languages with complex morphology add more variation but at the cost of occasional meaning drift
- Low-resource languages introduce too much noise



Evaluation: Syntactic Difference - Using (1 - BLEU) Score

- **High Resource Languages** (e.g. *de, zh, nl, es, fr*): wide variety of syntactic constructions
- **Moderate Resource Languages** (e.g. *sv, da, it, ar, hu*): introduce structural variation but some have literal carry-over
- **Low Resource Languages** (e.g. *mt, ml, mr*): almost no new syntactic patterns



Evaluation: Syntactic Difference - Parse Tree Distance

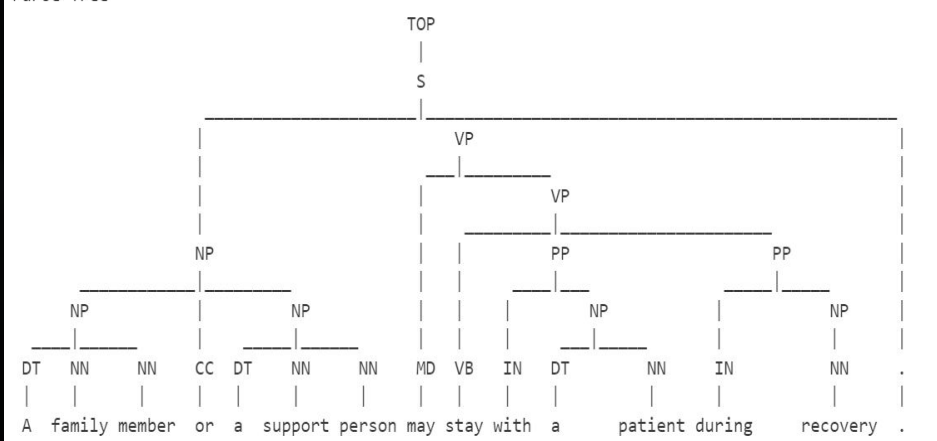
Original English: A family member or a support person may stay with a patient during recovery.

Bengali: কোনও পরিবারের সদস্য বা কোনও সমর্থন ব্যক্তি পুনরুদ্ধারের সময় রোগীর সাথে থাকতে পারেন।

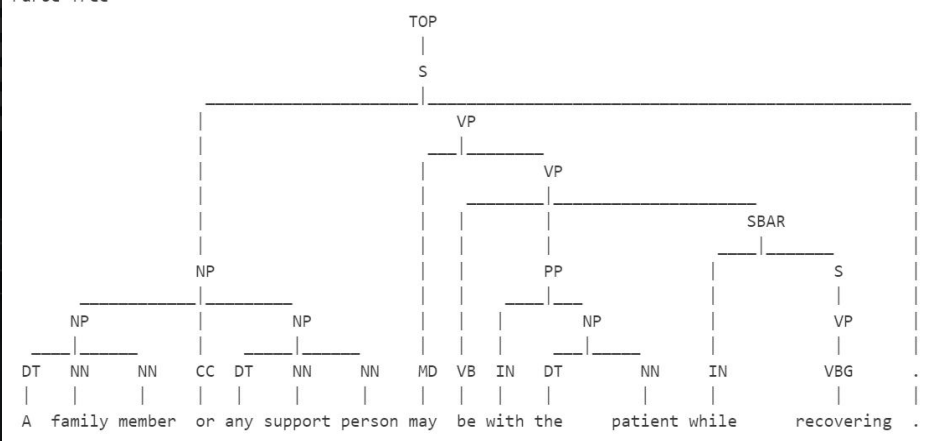
Back-Translated English: A family member or any support person may be with the patient while recovering.

Tree Edit Distance: 9.0

Parse Tree



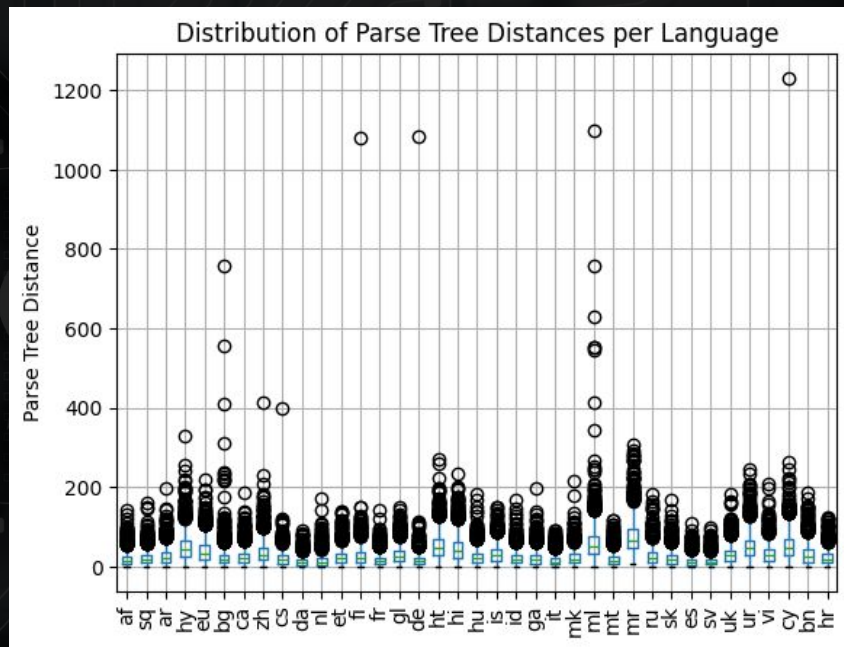
Parse Tree



Evaluation: Syntactic Difference

Using Parse Tree Distance

- Most languages show compact syntactic shifts; some (e.g., ml, cy, fi, de, bg) have high outliers.
- Languages like da, es, sv, it preserve syntax better (low median/spread).
- Language choice in back-translation are key for syntactic diversity.
- High outliers may aid augmentation but risk drift.



Evaluating the Quality of Augmented Texts

- LLaMA Evaluation
- Human Evaluation



```
Final Results:
      text                intermediate_af_hels \
0 The cat is on the mat                Die kat is op die mat
1 Dogs love to play fetch              Honde hou daarvan om te gaan haal

      augment_af_hels                intermediate_sq_hels \
0 [The cat's on the mat.]                Macja është në rrogozë.
1 [Dogs Love to Get]                    Qenve u pëlqen shumë të luajnë

      augment_sq_hels                intermediate_ar_hels                augment_ar_hels \
0 [The cat's on the mat.]                القطة على ما سئل [The cat is on record.]
1 [Dogs love to play.]                    الكلب يحب أن تلعب [Dogs like to play.]

      intermediate_hy_hels                augment_hy_hels \
0 Səvjetlərə gələn dənizə gələn [The Tropics are on the Tropics]
1 Əyləncəli oyunlar [The game loves playing.]

      intermediate_eu_hels ...                intermediate_te_gcp \
0 Katua alfonbran dago. ...                పిల్లి దాసు మీద ఉంది
1 Txakurrek maite dute jolasa. ...          కుక్కలు ఆడటానికి ఇష్టపడతాయి

      augment_te_gcp                intermediate_th_gcp                augment_th_gcp \
0 The cat is on the mat                แมวอยู่บนเสื่อ                Cat on the mat
1 Dogs prefer to play                  สุนัขชอบเล่น Fetch                Dogs like to play fetch

      intermediate_tr_gcp                augment_tr_gcp \
0 Kedi paspasın üzerinde                Cat on the mat
1 Köpekler getirmeyi sever              He likes to bring dogs

      intermediate_yi_gcp                augment_yi_gcp \
0 ה' קאטן איז אויף די מאט                The cat is on the mat
1 דאָס האָט ליב צו שפּילן ברענגען          Dogs love to play bring

      intermediate_zu_gcp                augment_zu_gcp
0 Ikati lise mat                        Ikati lise food
1 Izingja zithanda ukudlala zilandla    Dogs like to play and download
```



Evaluating the Quality of Augmented Texts

- LLaMA Evaluation

```
46
47 # Define prompt template
48 PROMPT_TEMPLATE = """
49 You are evaluating the quality of a sentence augmentation.
50 Given the original sentence and its augmented version, provide three scores:
51 1. **Semantic Preservation (0-100):** How well does the augmented sentence preserve the
    original meaning?
52 2. **Error Severity (0-100):** How incorrect is the augmentation? (Higher means more
    incorrect)
53 3. **Diversity Score (0-100):** How different is the augmentation structurally while still
    being valid?
54
55 Return scores in the format: `Semantic: X, Error: Y, Diversity: Z`.
56
57 Original: "{original}"
58 Augmented: "{augmented}"
59
60 Scores:
61 """
62
```

Evaluating the Quality of Augmented Texts

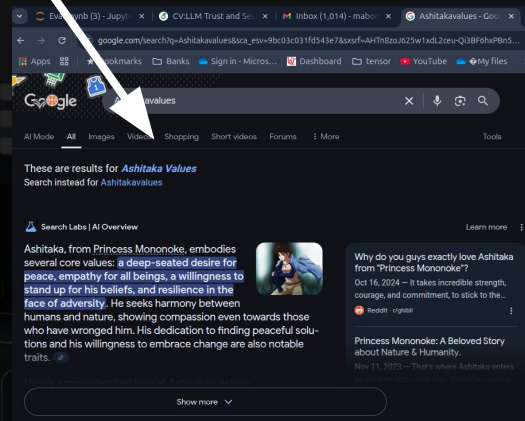
- **LLaMA Evaluation:** Does the LLaMa Method actually work?

```
sentence_id augmentation_column \  
7          7      augment_af_hels  
8          8      augment_af_hels  
9          9      augment_af_hels
```

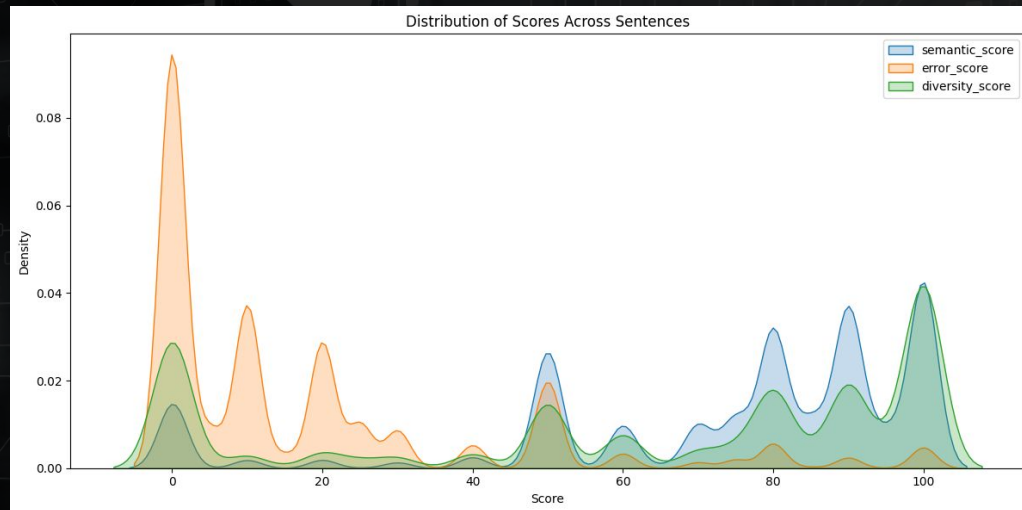
```
original text \  
7          It stretched 363 miles across New York State from the Hudson River in the east to Lake Erie in the west.  
8          The new development will therefore create connected spaces, accessible rooftops, pathways and passages.  
9 We generate a signal with the same frequency as frequency of pins 5 and 6 and after each pulse we change the duty cycle(values from the vector) with an interrupt.
```

```
augmented text \  
7          It stretched across New York State from the Hudson River in the east to Lake Erie in the west.  
8          Thus, the new development will create bandages, accessible roofs, paths, and corridors.  
9 We get a signal with the same frequency as frequency of pens 5 and 6 and after each pulse we change the duty cycle Ashitakavalues of the vector) with an interruption.
```

```
semantic_score error_score diversity_score  
7          100.0         0.0         0.0  
8          70.0         20.0         30.0  
9          80.0         50.0         40.0
```



Results And Findings: LLama



Many augmentations have high semantic + low error |
High diversity + low semantic + high error |
Low diversity + high semantic + low error |

✓ Useful
✗ Possibly harmful
🙄 Redundant

Evaluating the Quality of Augmented Texts

- Human Evaluation

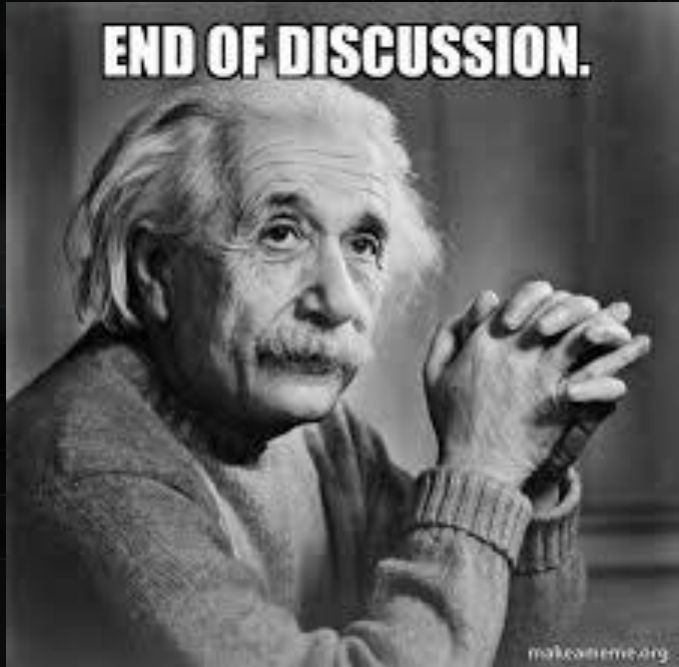
Original Text	It stretched 363 miles across New York State from the Hudson River in the east to Lake Erie in the west.	
Language	Translation	Back-Translation
Hindi (used Opus-MT)	इसने पश्चिम में हसन नदी से लेकर पश्चिम की झील तक ३,३३ किलोमीटर की दूरी तक फैला दी ।	This spread from the river Hwonham to the lake of Porkum on the west side of the lake of Ch'inknom, some 30 miles [50 km] from the river of Hocchim.
Urdu (used Opus-MT)	یہ مشرقی فرانس سے لیکر مشرقی سمت میں واقع نیشنل پارک سے، ۳۶ میل نور نیو یارک کے جنوب میں واقع ہے۔	It is located 36 miles [16 km] south of New York City from eastern France to East France.
Bengali (used GoogleTrans)	এটি পূর্বের হাডসন নদী থেকে পশ্চিমে লেক এরি লেক পর্যন্ত নিউইয়র্ক রাজ্য জুড়ে 363 মাইল প্রসারিত।	It extends 363 miles across the New York State from the East Hudson River to Lake Ery Lake to the west.
Malayalam (used Opus-MT)	അത് 363 കിലോമീറ്റർ നീളമുണ്ട്.	It's 363 miles [33 km] long.

Evaluating the Quality of Augmented Texts

- Human Evaluation

Original Text	It stretched 363 miles across New York State from the Hudson River in the east to Lake Erie in the west.			
Language	Semantic Preservation	Error Severity	Diversity Score	General Comments
Hindi (used Opus-MT)	25%	95%	80%	Translation to Hindi is decent - number mismatch, misses Erie's name, east vs west.
Urdu (used Opus-MT)	30%	90%	60%	Translation to Urdu - Sentence misses mixes up information. BT is relevant to the given Urdu sentence.
Bengali (used GoogleTrans)	95%	20%	10%	Translation to Bengali is perfect. There is a spelling mistake in the back-translation.
Malayalam (used Opus-MT)	75%	80%	70%	Translation to Malayalam - Sentence misses most information. BT is perfect for the Malayalam sentence.

Final Discussion And Thoughts



- Translation AUG are meh?! (Work well for generic data)
- Opus-MT tends to underperform compared to Mr.GoOgle man ...
- Google Translate BT has less diversity due to amazing translation
- Our Proposed LLama eval is some real big brain stuff...
- Is it a necessary gain?: We aren't the guy on our left.. But our study shows that it lets us down when it matters most..